

Tokyo Kissaten

喫茶店 — The art of slowness, served daily

35	\$38	22%	\$17.2k
SEATS	AVG SPEND	FOOD COST	EST. MONTHLY NET

ENTRÉES: 6 | MAINS: 10 | DESSERTS: 4 | DRINKS: 8

Chef's Lens

// WHAT A MICHELIN-TRAINED CHEF SEES IN TOKYO KISSATEN COOKING

The Tokyo kissaten operates on a philosophy that is almost impossible to find in commercial food culture: the belief that slowness is a service, not a failure. The pour-over coffee drips at its own pace. The morning set takes as long as it takes. The kissaten owner does not rush the customer. This is not inefficiency — it is the product. The matcha latte requires water at 80°C, not boiling: above that temperature, the matcha oxidises and turns bitter. The whisking technique matters: the chasen bamboo whisk creates a foam through the figure-eight motion that a blender cannot replicate. The thick toast is Shokupan — Japanese milk bread — with a crumb so soft it requires a specific knife technique to slice without compressing. Precision in service of gentleness.

// WHAT THIS GUIDE DOES

In a market saturated with fast coffee and performance café culture, the kissaten offers something increasingly rare: permission to slow down. The customer who wants quiet, a counter seat, and coffee taken seriously exists in every major US city and is currently underserved. The morning set at \$12.99 with a \$1.20 food cost funds a kitchen model that requires minimal equipment and a small, highly skilled team.

The margins are better than they look. This guide shows you how.

Entrées

Tamago Sando

Tamago Sando — Japanese Egg Salad Sandwich

TICKET: 5 min | FOOD COST: 14%

- 1 Soft-boil eggs for exactly 10 minutes, shock in ice bath, peel clean.
- 2 Mash eggs with Japanese mayo (Kewpie), season with salt and white pepper.
- 3 Spread filling evenly on Shokupan, crust removed, press firmly and slice diagonally.

The Kewpie mayo is non-negotiable. It has rice vinegar and egg yolk only — the flavour

profile is fundamentally different from Western mayo.

Eggs

Gluten

Chicken Katsu Sando

TICKET: 8 min | FOOD COST: 18%

- 1 Pound chicken breast to even 1cm thickness. Season, coat: flour → egg → panko.
- 2 Fry at 170°C for 4-5 minutes until golden. Drain on rack, not paper.
- 3 Spread tonkatsu sauce and Japanese mayo on Shokupan. Layer katsu, press, slice.

Gluten

Eggs

Tamagoyaki — Rolled Dashi Omelette

TICKET: 6 min | FOOD COST: 12%

- 1 Whisk 3 eggs with dashi, mirin, soy, and a pinch of sugar until combined.
- 2 Heat tamagoyaki pan over medium. Oil lightly. Pour thin layer, roll forward as it sets.
- 3 Repeat 3-4 layers, rolling each onto the previous. Shape in bamboo mat. Slice and serve.

The roll direction is consistent — always away from you. Muscle memory over method once trained.

Eggs

Soy

Gluten

Edamame Gyoza — Pan-fried, Ponzu

TICKET: 8 min | FOOD COST: 15%

- 1 Fill gyoza skins with edamame-ginger filling. Pleat and seal edges with water.
- 2 Pan-fry flat side down in oil, medium-high, until golden — about 2 minutes.
- 3 Add splash of water, cover immediately to steam. Uncover, cook dry. Serve with ponzu.

Gluten

Soy

Miso Soup & House Pickle Set

TICKET: 4 min | FOOD COST: 10%

- 1 Heat dashi to 65°C. Dissolve white miso — do not boil. Add tofu and wakame.
- 2 Plate house pickles: tsukemono of cucumber, daikon, and ginger.
- 3 Garnish miso with spring onion. Serve together in lacquered bowls.

Never boil miso — it destroys the live cultures and muddles the flavour. 65°C is the ceiling.

Soy

Gluten (miso)

Onigiri 2pc — Salmon Mayo & Tuna Nori

TICKET: 5 min | FOOD COST: 13%

- 1 Season sushi rice with rice vinegar and salt while still warm. Cool to hand-temperature.
- 2 Wet hands with salted water. Shape rice into triangle with filling in centre.
- 3 Wrap lower half in nori. Serve immediately — nori stays crisp for approx. 3 minutes.

Fish

Gluten (soy in tuna)

Eggs (mayo)

Mains

Shio Ramen — Signature

Shio Ramen — Clear Chicken-Pork Broth ★ Signature

TICKET: 12 min | FOOD COST: 16% | BROTH: 4hr min prep

- 1 Broth starts at 07:00 daily. Simmer chicken carcasses and pork neck bones 4hr minimum. Skim constantly first 30 min.
- 2 Season with shio tare (sea salt, sake, mirin). Broth should be crystal clear — never cloudy.
- 3 Cook fresh ramen noodles 90 seconds. Plate broth at 85°C, add noodles, chashu, ajitsuke tamago, nori, menma.

The clarity of shio ramen is its identity. Cloudy broth means rushed technique. The patience in the pot translates directly to the bowl.

Gluten

Pork

Eggs

Japanese Beef Curry Rice

TICKET: 10 min | FOOD COST: 19%

- 1 Curry base made in batches. Sauté onion until deeply caramelised — minimum 25 min.
- 2 Add beef, potato, carrot. Simmer with S&B curry roux until thick and glossy.
- 3 Plate Japanese rice on right side of oval plate. Ladle curry on left. Garnish with fukujinzuke.

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Gluten (roux)

Dairy (some roux brands)

Oyakodon — Chicken & Egg Rice Bowl

TICKET: 8 min | FOOD COST: 17%

- 1 Simmer chicken thigh in dashi, soy, mirin, sugar in small oyakodon pan until cooked through.
- 2 Add sliced onion, soften 2 min. Pour beaten egg over in spiral — do not stir.
- 3 Cover 30 seconds. Egg should be 80% set, custardy. Slide immediately over hot rice. Garnish mitsuba.

The custard set is the entire dish. Over-cooked egg is scrambled egg on rice — technically wrong. The residual heat of the rice finishes the cook.

Eggs

Soy

Gluten

Teriyaki Salmon Don

TICKET: 10 min | FOOD COST: 20%

- 1 Score salmon skin. Sear skin-side down in oil, medium-high, 4 minutes until crispy. Flip 90 seconds.
- 2 Glaze with teriyaki (soy, mirin, sake, sugar) in final 30 seconds. Rest 1 minute before slicing.
- 3 Serve over Japanese short-grain rice with pickled ginger, julienned cucumber, sesame.

Fish

Soy

Gluten

Pork Katsu Curry

TICKET: 12 min | FOOD COST: 18%

- 1 Prepare pork cutlet as per Chicken Katsu method — panko, 170°C, drain on rack.
- 2 Plate rice, ladle curry from batch over half. Slice katsu and fan over curry.
- 3 Garnish with fukujinzuke. Serve with tonkatsu sauce on the side.

Gluten

Eggs

Pork

Cold Soba — House Tsuyu Dipping Noodles

TICKET: 6 min | FOOD COST: 14%

- 1 Cook soba 4 minutes in boiling water. Drain and rinse immediately in cold running water.
- 2 Plate soba on bamboo zaru. Serve tsuyu (dashi, soy, mirin concentrate) in chilled cup alongside.

- 3 Condiments: wasabi, sliced spring onion, nori strips. Instruct customer on dipping ratio.

Gluten (wheat soba) Soy

Mentaiko Pasta

TICKET: 10 min | FOOD COST: 16%

- 1 Cook spaghetti al dente. Reserve 60ml pasta water.
- 2 Mix mentaiko roe with butter, cream, soy, and lemon juice off-heat.
- 3 Toss pasta in sauce with pasta water to emulsify. Do not heat — mentaiko should stay raw and bright. Garnish nori, shiso, extra roe.

Fish (mentaiko) Gluten Dairy

Napolitan Spaghetti

TICKET: 10 min | FOOD COST: 15%

- 1 Sauté onion, capsicum, mushroom, and Vienna sausage slices in butter.
- 2 Add ketchup, Worcestershire, and a dash of Tabasco. Toss with pre-cooked spaghetti.
- 3 Plate in oval dish. Garnish with parsley and grated Parmesan. Serve with Tabasco on table.

Napolitan is a Showa-era kissaten classic — deliberately retro, deliberately comforting. The ketchup base is authentic. Do not attempt to elevate it with fresh tomato.

Gluten Dairy Pork (sausage)

Yakitori Plate — 5 Skewers

TICKET: 12 min | FOOD COST: 17%

- 1 Skewer chicken thigh and spring onion alternating. Skewer negima, tsukune, liver, skin separately.
- 2 Grill over charcoal or high broiler. Baste with tare (soy, mirin, sake, sugar) during last 2 minutes.
- 3 Plate on yakitori holder. Serve with sansho pepper, yuzu kosho, and lemon wedge.

Soy Gluten (tare)

Hiyashi Chuka — Cold Noodle Salad

TICKET: 8 min | FOOD COST: 14%

- 1 Cook ramen noodles, rinse cold, toss in sesame oil to prevent sticking.
- 2 Arrange toppings in radial sections: julienned cucumber, egg strips, ham, tomato, wakame.

3 Pour chilled tsuyu-sesame dressing over table. Garnish with mustard, pickled ginger.

Gluten Eggs Sesame

Desserts

Item	Ticket	Food Cost	Notes
Matcha Tiramisu	5 min	13%	Matcha soaked ladyfingers, mascarpone cream, dusted matcha
Hojicha Panna Cotta	3 min	11%	Pre-set. Plate with roasted hojicha syrup and gold flake
Dorayaki 2pc — Red Bean Pancakes	4 min	10%	Fluffy pancakes, house anko filling. Serve warm.
Kakigori — Japanese Shaved Ice	5 min	12%	Machine-shaved, not crushed. Matcha, condensed milk, anko

10-13% 4 items 3-5 min
DESSERT FC RANGE MENU COUNT MAX TICKET TIME

Allergen Summary — Desserts

Matcha Tiramisu: Gluten, Eggs, Dairy Hojicha Panna Cotta: Dairy
Dorayaki: Gluten, Eggs, Red Bean Kakigori: Dairy

Drinks

Pour-Over Coffee — Single Origin

\$6.99 | FC: 12%

Ground to order. 4 minute brew. Rotates weekly.

Matcha Latte — 80°C, Chasen Whisked

\$6.99 | FC: 11%

Never above 80°C. Chasen whisk only. Dairy allergen.

Hojicha Latte

\$6.99

Roasted green tea, steamed oat or dairy milk.

Morning Set — Coffee + Toast + Egg

\$12.99 | **FC: \$1.20**

Highest margin item on menu. Anchor the morning.

Canned Chu-Hi — Lemon Sour

\$5.99

Serve chilled in can with glass of ice.

Asahi Super Dry

\$6.99

Serve at 2–4°C. Pre-chill glasses.

Yuzu Soda

\$4.99

House yuzu syrup, sparkling water, ice.

Cold Brew Concentrate

\$5.99

18hr cold steep. Dilute 1:1 over ice. Instant serve.

Service Scripts

WELCOME + POUR-OVER EXPLANATION

"The coffee is pour-over — single origin, ground to order. It takes 4 minutes. If you're in a rush, the cold brew is instant and very good. But the pour-over is worth the 4 minutes."

MATCHA LATTE TEMPERATURE NOTE

"The matcha is whisked at 80°C — not boiling. Above that it oxidises and turns bitter. It takes a minute longer. That's why it tastes like matcha and not grass."

MORNING SET PITCH

"The morning set is coffee, thick toast with butter, and a soft-boiled egg. \$12.99. It's a Japanese breakfast — slow, deliberate. We don't rush it."

KISSATEN PHILOSOPHY

"This is a kissaten — a Japanese coffee shop that's been around since the 1950s. The concept is slowness. You're welcome to stay as long as you like."

RETURN VISIT

"We change the single-origin coffee weekly. If you liked today's, ask us what it was — we write it on the board by the bar. Next week is different."

Daily Prep Schedule

Time	Task	Notes
07:00	Ramen broth on	4hr minimum simmer. Skim first 30 min aggressively.
08:00	Tamagoyaki prep	Batch for morning service. Cover and hold warm.
08:30	Onigiri assembly	Wrap and hold. Nori applied to order only.
09:00	Open + pour-over calibration	Grind test, bloom check, scale tare, board update.
10:00	Lunch mise en place	Rice on, curry heated, soba prepped, gyoza filled.
11:30	Lunch service begins	Full menu available. 35 covers max.
14:30	Lunch reset	Clean stations. Broth top-up. Restock mise.
15:00	Afternoon coffee service	Coffee, light bites, desserts only.
17:30	Dinner mise en place	Yakitori skewers ready. Rice fresh batch. Full prep.
18:00	Dinner service begins	Full menu. Alcohol available from this service.
21:00	Close	Deep clean stations. Log waste. Count broth yield.

Profit & Loss Overview

Metric	Figure	% of Revenue
Daily Revenue	~\$1,900	—
Weekly Revenue	~\$11,400	—
Monthly Revenue	~\$49,400	100%
Food Cost (22%)	~\$10,868	22%
Labour Cost (28%)	~\$13,832	28%
Overheads (15%)	~\$7,410	15%
Est. Monthly Net	~\$17,290	~35%

\$3835~5035%

AVG SPEND / COVERSEATSCOVERS / DAY (EST.)NET MARGIN

The morning set at \$12.99 with a \$1.20 food cost (9.2% FC) is the engine. At 20 covers per

morning service, that's \$259 revenue at under \$25 food cost. Build the open around it.

Allergen Matrix

Staff must verify all allergens at point of order. Menu items below flagged with primary allergens. Always check with kitchen for current prep.

Item	Allergens
Tamago Sando	EggsGluten
Chicken Katsu Sando	GlutenEggs
Edamame Gyoza	GlutenSoy
Shio Ramen	GlutenPork
Matcha Latte	Dairy
Dorayaki 2pc	GlutenEggsRed Bean
Kakigori	Dairy
Yakitori Plate	Soy